

Anouk Stillwater

Character Dossier

Quietly ambitious ring announcer of the Frostwall garrison on the northern border

Overview

Anouk Stillwater is a ring announcer living in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border. Anouk is 26 years old, originally from Little Ashby, and is known around the east rampart as quietly ambitious. In conversation Anouk refuses to say the word 'no' outright.

Background

Anouk arrived in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border 19 years ago after leaving Little Ashby under circumstances Anouk describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Frostwall Legion; the second was the one that stuck. Today Anouk works as a ring announcer near the quartermaster's stores and is paid, when paid at all, in iron pennies.

Anouk learned the trade from Tomasz Nightingale, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Anouk's life is with Nadira Hartwell, over a matter neither will explain. The person Anouk trusts most is Pilar Greywind.

Current goal: to build a boat with no nails in it. Greatest fear: mirrors in the dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: quietly ambitious.

Speech pattern: Anouk refuses to say the word 'no' outright.

Tells: when lying, Anouk mentions Whistle the lizard for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Anouk Stillwater
<i>Role</i>	ring announcer
<i>Home</i>	the Frostwall garrison on the northern border
<i>Hometown</i>	Little Ashby
<i>Age</i>	26
<i>Favourite dish</i>	hand-rolled cardamom buns
<i>Pet</i>	Whistle, a lizard
<i>Lucky number</i>	286

<i>Workshop password</i>	anvil-willow
<i>Mentor</i>	Tomasz Nightingale
<i>Rival</i>	Nadira Hartwell
<i>Closest friend</i>	Pilar Greywind

Secret

Anouk once turned down an offer from the Frostwall Legion that would have made them rich, and wonders about it nightly.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Anouk: I am the ring announcer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Anouk: Hand-rolled cardamom buns. Do not tell Nadira I said so.

Visitor: Is Whistle yours?

Anouk: Whistle belongs to nobody. Whistle tolerates me. Lucky number is 286, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 6

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the tax on doors. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Anouk won 80 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. Anouk repaired the sextant at the quartermaster's stores for Hollis, who paid in 34 iron pennies and a long story about the quarantine.

Entry 2, summer of year 6

A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk repaired the oilskin map at the mess hall for Tiberius, who paid in 42 iron pennies and a long story about the missing shipment. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the quarantine. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right.

Entry 3, autumn of year 6

Anouk found a cracked compass half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a hand bell on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right. Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 4, spring of year 6

Anouk won 62 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. Anouk found a bolt of linen half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 5, autumn of year 7

Anouk repaired the signal flag at the mess hall for Teodora, who paid in 53 iron pennies and a long story about the tariff on salt. At the mess hall, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 6, autumn of year 7

A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 8 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short. Anouk was hired to carry a coil of rope from the quartermaster's stores to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 7, summer of year 7

The weather turned. Anouk moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Whistle, and wrote three lines to Tomasz about whether the bridge will hold. At the signal tower, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 68 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Anouk won 34 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. At the signal tower, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 8, winter of year 7

Anouk repaired the bolt of linen at the mess hall for Amadou, who paid in 65 iron pennies and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 4 of everything, except the clockwork bird, which is always short. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 55 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short.

Entry 9, autumn of year 7

A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk repaired the grain scale at the mess hall for Torvald, who paid in 5 iron pennies and a long story about the singing at the docks. Anouk closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Whistle followed at a distance.

Entry 10, spring of year 7

A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 38 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. Anouk was hired to carry a signal flag from the quartermaster's stores to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 11, summer of year 7

Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right. Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the mess hall. Anouk pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right.

Entry 12, autumn of year 7

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the old tunnels. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the census reached the frozen moat. Anouk pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Anouk closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Whistle followed at a distance.

Entry 13, summer of year 7

A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Anouk was hired to carry a cracked compass from the frozen moat to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 14, autumn of year 7

Nikolai came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Anouk said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Anouk repaired the copper pipe at the frozen moat for Teodora, who paid in 17 iron pennies and a long story about the old tunnels. Anouk repaired the hand bell at the frozen moat for Yusuf, who paid in 57 iron pennies and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. The weather turned. Anouk moved the grain scale indoors, fed Whistle, and wrote three lines to Tomasz about the new curfew.

Entry 15, spring of year 7

Anouk won 58 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. A dispute over the comet flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the frozen moat, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. Anouk repaired the clockwork bird at the frozen moat for Freya, who paid in 33 iron pennies and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. The weather turned. Anouk moved the spool of wire indoors, fed Whistle, and wrote three lines to Tomasz about the census.

Entry 16, spring of year 7

Anouk won 18 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the harvest count. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Anouk won 22 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached the mess hall. Anouk pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 17, summer of year 7

A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the comet. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Anouk won 88 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. Anouk found a sack of salt half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 18, winter of year 7

Anouk closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Whistle followed at a distance. Anouk closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Whistle followed at a distance. At the east rampart, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 19, spring of year 7

Anouk repaired the wax seal at the mess hall for Rhoswen, who paid in 65 iron pennies and a long story about the quarantine. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the old tunnels. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 20, spring of year 7

A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Anouk found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the tax on doors. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 88 of everything, except the spool of wire, which is always short.

Entry 21, spring of year 8

A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk won 80 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 22, summer of year 8

Zora came by asking about the tax on doors. Anouk said nothing useful and made tea instead. Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the signal tower, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 23, autumn of year 8

Anouk repaired the ledger at the frozen moat for Mara, who paid in 89 iron pennies and a long story about the singing at the docks. Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 24, winter of year 8

Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before. Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. Anouk was hired to carry a coil of rope from the signal tower to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk was hired to carry a iron kettle from the signal tower to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 25, spring of year 8

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right.

Entry 26, autumn of year 8

Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the east rampart, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the east rampart: 56 of everything, except the clockwork bird, which is always short.

Entry 27, winter of year 8

Anouk found a cracked compass half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the signal tower. Anouk pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Anouk repaired the copper pipe at the signal tower for Halcyon, who paid in 4 iron pennies and a long story about the tax on doors. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 49 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the signal tower. Anouk pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 28, spring of year 8

A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the frozen moat to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 43 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short. Tallulah came by asking about the tariff on salt. Anouk said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 29, summer of year 8

Anouk was hired to carry a oilskin map from the mess hall to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Anouk repaired the iron kettle at the mess hall for Corvina, who paid in 33 iron pennies and a long story about the old tunnels. Anouk repaired the sack of salt at the mess hall for Isadora, who paid in 70 iron pennies and a long story about the old tunnels. Anouk repaired the sextant at the mess hall for Dorothea, who paid in 52 iron pennies and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the census. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 30, autumn of year 8

Anouk repaired the bolt of linen at the mess hall for Mara, who paid in 85 iron pennies and a long story about the comet. Anouk won 13 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. Anouk repaired the bundle of letters at the mess hall for Vesna, who paid in 15 iron pennies and a long story about the missing shipment.

Entry 31, winter of year 8

A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Anouk moved the grain scale indoors, fed Whistle, and wrote three lines to Tomasz about the old tunnels. At the signal tower, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real bundle of letters from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 32, summer of year 8

Anouk won 36 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. Anouk won 12 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. Anouk found a copper pipe half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 33, autumn of year 8

Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right. The weather turned. Anouk moved the bundle of letters indoors, fed Whistle, and wrote three lines to Tomasz about the new curfew. Rumours about the comet reached the east rampart. Anouk pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 34, spring of year 8

Anouk closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Whistle followed at a distance. Anouk was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the east rampart to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Anouk won 29 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. Anouk closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Whistle followed at a distance. Anouk repaired the ledger at the east rampart for Thaddeus, who paid in 82 iron pennies and a long story about the missing shipment.

Entry 35, spring of year 8

Anouk was hired to carry a sextant from the quartermaster's stores to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At the quartermaster's stores, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone. Anouk found a cracked compass half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 69 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the new curfew. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 36, winter of year 8

Anouk repaired the sextant at the quartermaster's stores for Hyacinth, who paid in 90 iron pennies and a long story about the right way to mend a net. Anouk was hired to carry a tin whistle from the quartermaster's stores to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. The weather turned. Anouk moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Whistle, and wrote three lines to Tomasz about the census. A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk won 5 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about who really won the regatta

and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns.

Entry 37, winter of year 8

Anouk spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 33 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right. Anouk closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Whistle followed at a distance. Anouk repaired the wax seal at the frozen moat for Gustav, who paid in 6 iron pennies and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 38, autumn of year 8

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Anouk moved the glass float indoors, fed Whistle, and wrote three lines to Tomasz about the census. At the mess hall, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone. Torvald came by asking about the harvest count. Anouk said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 39, summer of year 8

Anouk won 21 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. Anouk closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Whistle followed at a distance. Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. Anouk won 56 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns.

Entry 40, autumn of year 8

Anouk found a signal flag half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the census flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Anouk won 79 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 41, winter of year 8

Anouk found a copper pipe half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right. Anouk repaired the ledger at the frozen moat for Elowen, who paid in 40 iron pennies and a long story about the new curfew. Anouk found a brass lantern half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 42, summer of year 8

Anouk spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 60 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 10 of everything, except the spool of wire, which is always short. At the frozen moat, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real sextant from a

fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 43, spring of year 8

Anouk found a sextant half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Anouk won 45 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. The weather turned. Anouk moved the ledger indoors, fed Whistle, and wrote three lines to Tomasz about the new curfew. Anouk was hired to carry a oilskin map from the quartermaster's stores to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 44, spring of year 8

A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the quarantine reached the frozen moat. Anouk pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 45, summer of year 9

A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right. Rumours about the harvest count reached the frozen moat. Anouk pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 46, summer of year 9

Anouk spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 21 of everything, except the spool of wire, which is always short. Anouk won 77 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns. Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached the signal tower. Anouk pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 47, winter of year 9

A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk was hired to carry a copper pipe from the east rampart to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Xiomara came by asking about the tax on doors. Anouk said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Anouk for the password to the workshop. Anouk laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 48, summer of year 9

A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Anouk repaired the sack of salt at the frozen moat for Orsolya, who paid in 43 iron pennies and a long story about the census. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the quarantine. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Anouk won 16 iron pennies from Nadira on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on hand-rolled cardamom buns.

Entry 49, summer of year 9

Anouk found a brass lantern half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rumours about the comet reached the mess hall. Anouk pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 50, winter of year 9

A dispute over the comet flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over the census flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Anouk was hired to carry a brass lantern from the quartermaster's stores to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 51, spring of year 9

Valentin came by asking about the old tunnels. Anouk said nothing useful and made tea instead. Tomasz visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the new curfew. Anouk read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 52, spring of year 9

Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Anouk suspects Pilar and is probably right. Anouk was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the mess hall to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Gustav came by asking about the tax on doors. Anouk said nothing useful and made tea instead. Anouk was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the mess hall to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 53, spring of year 9

The weather turned. Anouk moved the glass float indoors, fed Whistle, and wrote three lines to Tomasz about the missing shipment. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Anouk and Nadira outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Anouk moved the bolt of linen indoors, fed Whistle, and wrote three lines to Tomasz about the census.

Entry 54, winter of year 9

Anouk closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Whistle followed at a distance. Qadira came by asking about the census. Anouk said nothing useful and made tea instead. At the frozen moat, Anouk taught Pilar how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Anouk found a clockwork bird half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Anouk spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 77 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short.